

Nothing you feel using Blinkit

India's Last Minute App - Reverse Engineered — 5 Moods, 1 App & the Design Decisions Behind Every Flow

A user-first teardown of how Blinkit shapes behaviour & what it shows about product thinking

BY SUDHARSAN

When did you last feel friction on Blinkit?

You can't remember and that's the most deliberately designed thing about **it**

I didn't study features. I studied what the app makes you do.

1

Entered through people, not menus

I walked real journeys — a user in a real moment — not the Home / Categories / Profile tour the builders filed the app under.

2

Segmented by job × constraint

Not by age or income. What predicts behaviour is the job someone opened the app to do and the one thing they won't trade.

3

Committed a hypothesis, then tested it

On every screen I named what I thought the design was doing — then looked for what would prove me wrong.

“

The user lives in feelings.

**The PM lives in the
decisions beneath them.**

Five modes — not five people.

The same person enters a different mode each time they open the app. Each mode wants a different thing — and feels a different thing.

Urgency	Reorder	Stock-up	High-value	Explorer
Out of Bread for Breakfast, Time to start for Office	The monthly staples, again	Restocking the week's kitchen	A ₹25,000 phone as a gift	Opened with no list at all
CONSTRAINT	CONSTRAINT	CONSTRAINT	CONSTRAINT	CONSTRAINT
TIME	EFFORT	VALUE	TRUST	—
FEELS	FEELS	FEELS	FEELS	FEELS
Relief	"That was easy"	Pride	Reassurance	Manufactured want

Persona 1 • Urgency

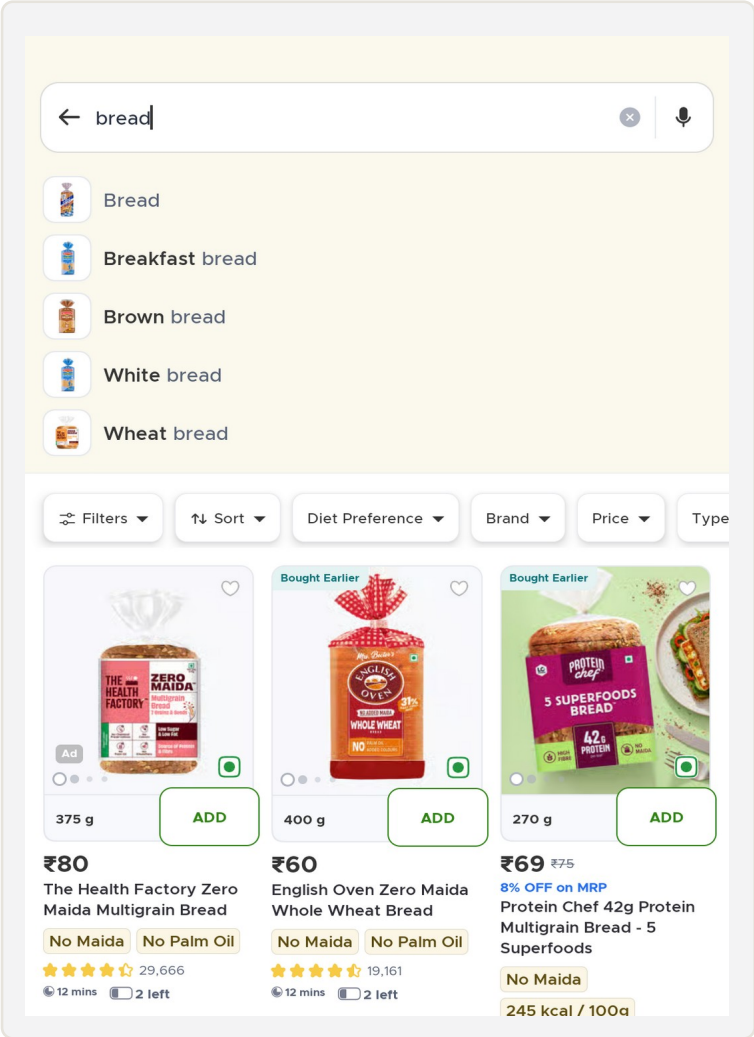
The app kills decision-making for the panicked user.

8am, out of Bread, Day starts with Breakfast

CONSTRAINT: TIME

One tap on “Bought Earlier” — no browsing, no comparing, no thinking. The panicked user is steered to the fastest possible checkout.

FEELS: RELIEF



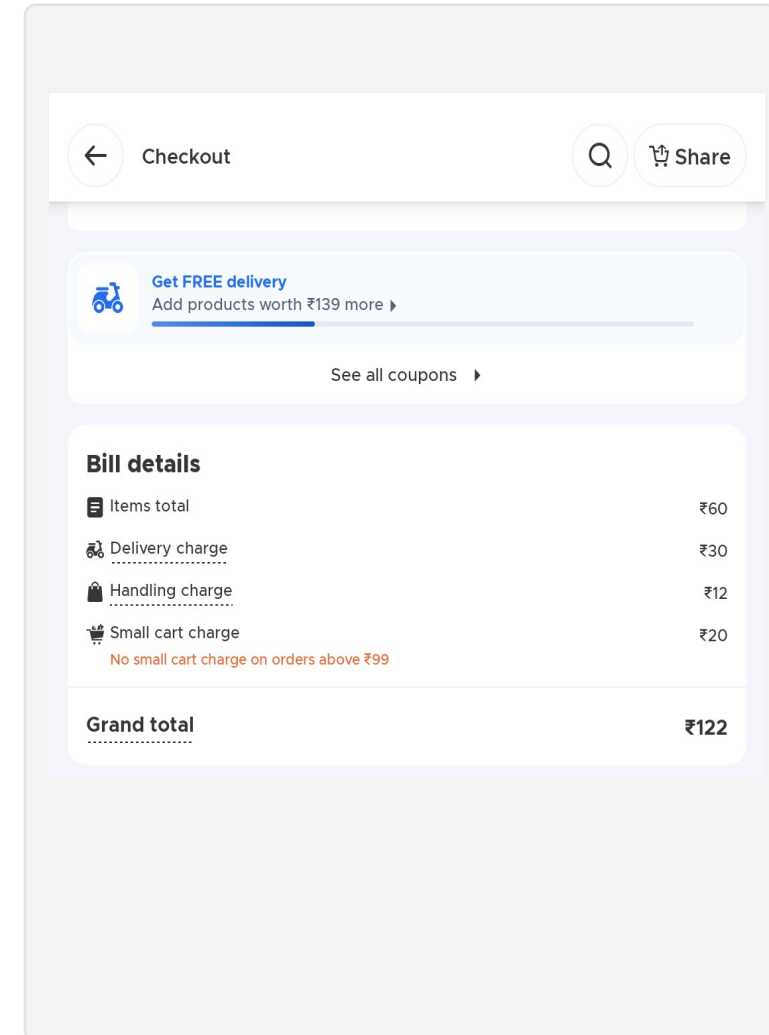
Persona 1 • Urgency

A ₹60 item became **₹122** — and I paid anyway.

The fees are a **lever, not a price** — they make a small, urgent order carry its full cost and nudge you toward a bigger basket.

The urgency user feels it, but won't switch.

FEELS: GUILT



Persona 1 • Urgency

The moat isn't speed. It's the reflex of which app you open.

The products are identical. Same SKUs, same riders, roughly the same time — so switching cost is almost zero. I felt it myself: mid-order, I nearly jumped to a rival.

So the moat isn't any single feature. It's being the app your thumb opens **before you think**. Ten-minute speed isn't logistics — it's how you become that reflex. And the reflex is built from **dark-store density, not marketing**.

≈ 0

switching cost between apps

Relief

the feeling the moat is built on — engineered,
not accidental

Persona 2 • Reorder

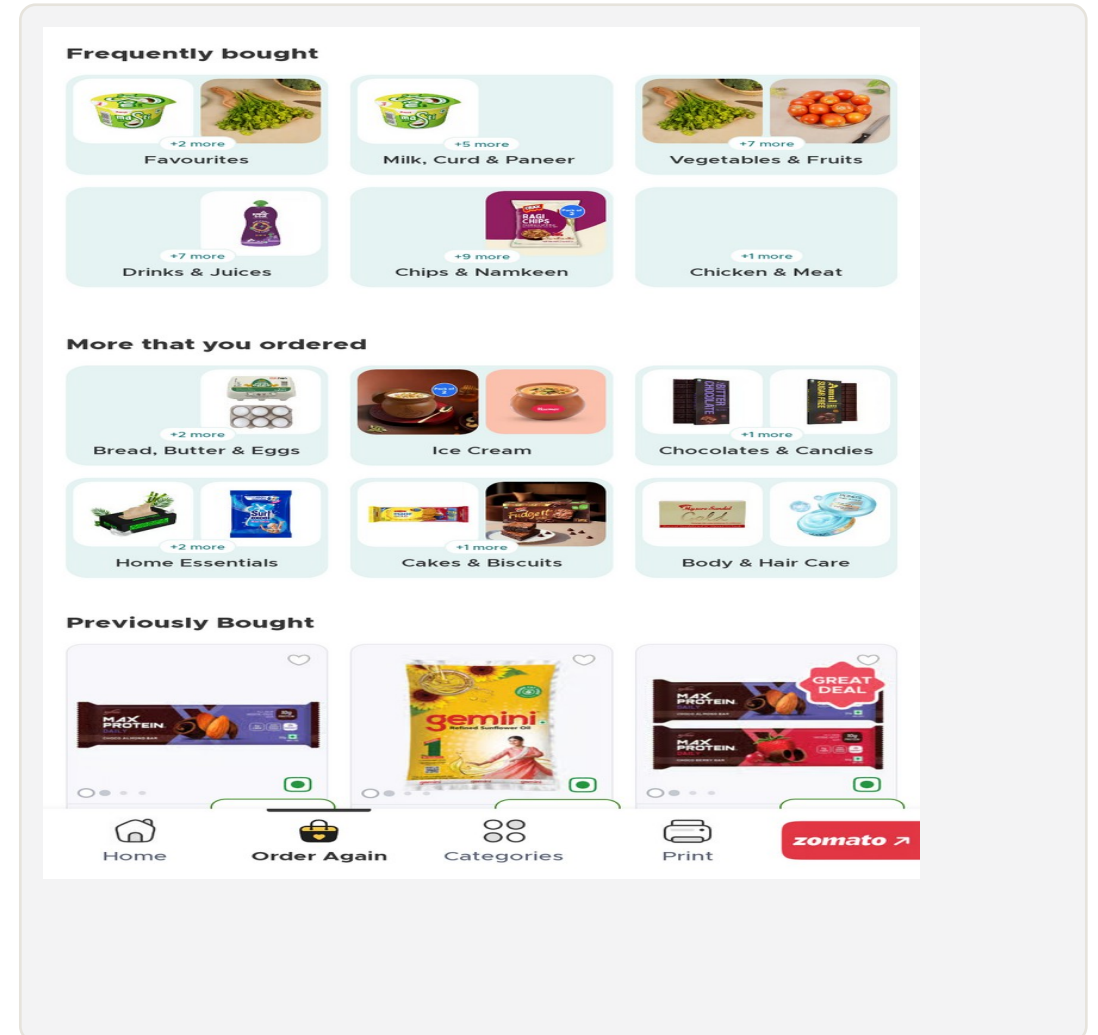
Friction is offered, not imposed.

Monthly staples, again.

CONSTRAINT: MINIMUM EFFORT

A dedicated “Order Again,” and upsells colour-coded into a lane the eye skips. The user's own attention sorts the fast path from the noise — the app never forces it.

FEELS: “THAT WAS EASY”



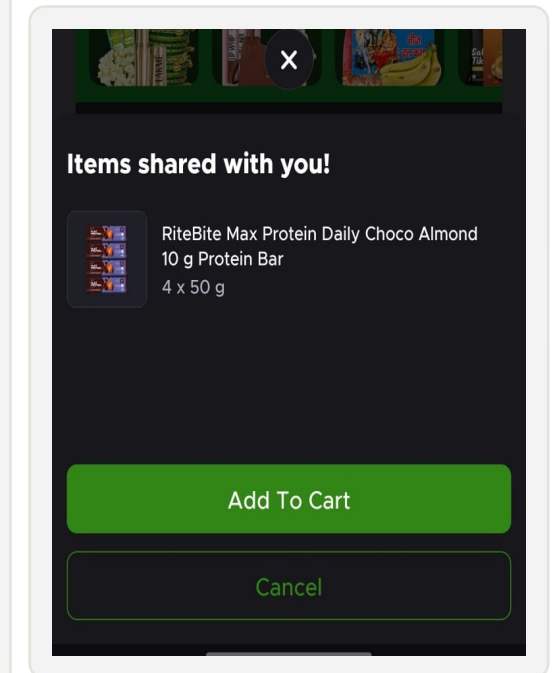
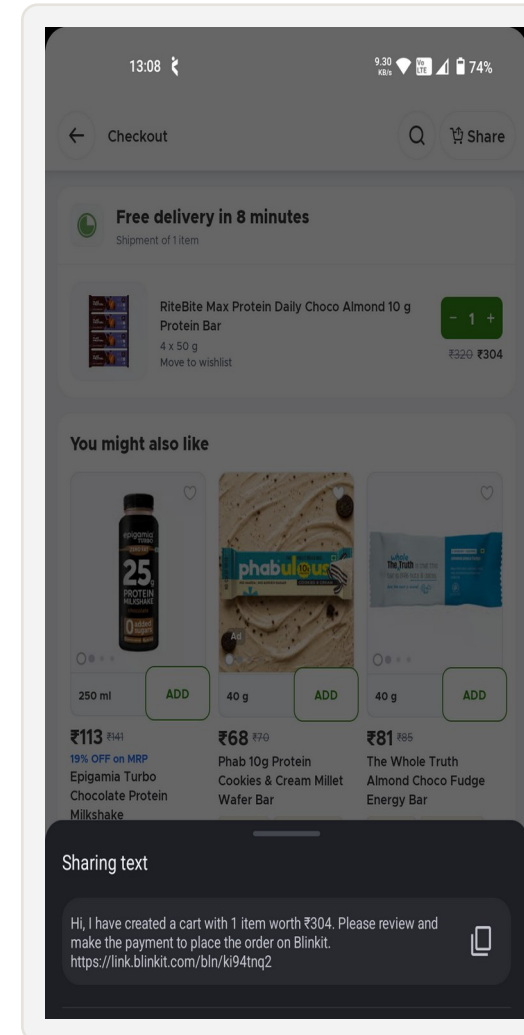
Persona 2 • Share Cart

A checkout button with nothing to do with groceries.

“Share cart” does **three jobs at once** — convenience, a bigger basket, and a **zero-cost viral loop**: the link opens or installs Blinkit on a friend's phone, pre-filled. It shows only when the user has time — the urgency user never sees it.

Every order can recruit the next user — for free.

The feeling it spreads: the relief you just felt, handed to someone else.



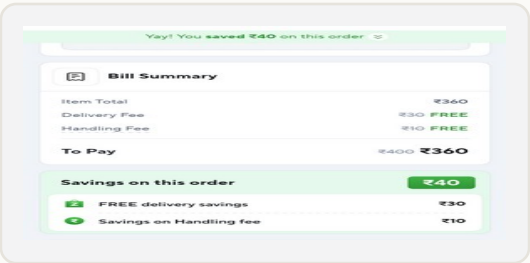
You share → they receive

Persona 3 • Stock-Up

STOCK-UP • VALUE

₹369 vs ₹360

Same cart, Blinkit vs Zepto. Blinkit waives delivery on a big basket but never the handling fee — its one always-on charge, and the thing a price-sensitive user can switch over.

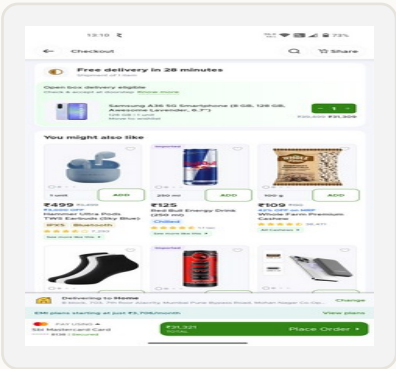


Persona 3 • High- Value

HIGH-VALUE • TRUST

Sells on trust, not speed

Nobody buys a ₹31,000 phone from an app they don't already trust — so open-box delivery, returns and a longer ETA carry the risk Blinkit absorbs on a product it didn't make.

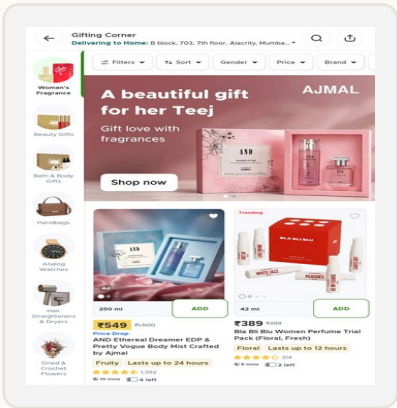


Persona 3 • Explorer

EXPLORER • NO GOAL

Manufactures an occasion

Opened with no list. Festival gifting gives a reason to buy — urgency makes you buy now; occasion makes you buy at all.



THE ANSWER

Five moods. One person. One plan.

They were never five users — they're **one person in five occasions**. Blinkit wins them one occasion at a time, and every occasion it captures makes the next easier and switching harder — until the trust built on curd and bread is what makes a ₹31,000 phone possible, and leaving becomes unthinkable.

Own every occasion → own the habit → the moat thickens.

HOW I READ A PRODUCT

**Products aren't features.
They're jobs and every feeling is a decision someone made
for you.**

Find the feeling. Trace it to the decision. That's the whole job.